

Let's look at US site *Little Black Bag*. Mimicking Japanese department stores 'fukurburo' (lucky bag) sales, shoppers here receive a mystery bag with a selection of fashion and beauty products every month. They then get a week to trade with other users to make their perfect collection and the excitement is increased further by the fact that select bags contain prizes worth 4 to 5 times the value of the bags.



Another example is Nev-erlikeditanyway.com, which is like an eBay for the broken hearted. Users that have been heart broken from a previous relationship upload images of an item that for them has bad memories and then give it a 'break-up price' which is much lower than what it would be worth in the real world so that sneaky buyers looking for a bargain can snap up these reduced price items.

Online classifieds sites such as Quickr.com and Olx.com in India are also community based. They use the age-old model of connecting buyers with sellers and have established a great following. Any user that wants to sell his old television or is looking for a second-hand car now but doesn't want to scour the local market can post their requirements or quote a price for their goods and instantly be connected to a community that would be interested in purchasing or selling those to them. Over time, these sites have also evolved rapidly and are used for connecting people to just about anything be it classes, real estate, jobs, cars, matrimonial, vehicles – the list just keeps on going.

These are just a few of the many examples of community-based e-commerce. What's great about them is that have harnessed the best part of being online – mass collaboration and social networking and plugged it into a model where shoppers can use the power of the crowd in new and innovative ways.

Aggregators

While e-commerce often promises low prices and the latest products, sometimes finding the best price can be difficult and/or time consuming.